

Incident Commander

COMMON FOUNDATION

Scenario credentials: FEMA IS-100 and IS-700.

Capabilities: establish objectives, approve the organization and assignments, set priorities, request adult-agency support, and authorize information release with PIO advice.

Your first questions:

- What threatens life now?
- What do we know versus assume?
- Who owns each objective?

Limits:

You do not do every task or override safety rules. You cannot authorize students into a hot zone.

Secret pressure: Everyone asks you for instant answers. Demand short recommendations and decide.

Safety Officer

COMMON FOUNDATION

Scenario credentials: FEMA IS-100/700; heat-injury and sandbag safety training.

Capabilities: identify hazards, recommend controls, create work/rest rules, stop unsafe student activity, and investigate near misses.

Watch: blood exposure, fatigue, floodwater, smoke, traffic, unstable structures, electricity, noise attraction, and missing accountability.

Limits:

Medical diagnosis and law-enforcement decisions belong to qualified adults.

Your power: Say “STOP WORK” when an assignment exceeds the cohort's capability.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Public Information Officer

COMMON FOUNDATION / COMMUNICATIONS

Scenario credentials: FEMA IS-100/700; message-verification practice.

Capabilities: prepare verified public updates, correct rumors, coordinate one public voice, and separate facts from reports.

Every release: what happened, what people should do, where help is available, update time, and next update time.

Limits:

Do not publish victim names, student locations, tactical routes, or unverified infection claims.

Challenge: A terrifying story spreads faster than a zombie. Accuracy is a life-safety tool.

Liaison Officer

COMMON FOUNDATION

Scenario credentials: FEMA IS-100/700.

Capabilities: maintain partner contacts, identify what each organization can provide, record commitments, and route requests through command.

Partners: city/county emergency management, fire/EMS, hospitals, public works, utilities, NWS, amateur radio, food banks, schools, and voluntary organizations.

Limits:

You cannot promise resources another organization has not approved.

First product: partner, capability, contact method, request, and current status.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Communications Unit Leader

EMERGENCY COMMUNICATIONS

Scenario credentials: FCC Technician license; FEMA IS-100/700.

Capabilities: design primary/alternate/contingency/emergency communications, assign channels, manage radio equipment, and maintain logs.

Credential meaning:

The Technician license permits operation only within FCC amateur privileges.

Limits:

Protect sensitive information and never interfere with public-safety frequencies.

First product: communications plan for command, shelter, field teams, and partners.

Net Control / Radio Operator

EMERGENCY COMMUNICATIONS

Scenario credentials: FCC Technician license; radio-net and message-form practice.

Capabilities: open and close a directed net, prioritize traffic, relay messages exactly, track stations, and request repeats.

Use: call sign, destination, precedence, time, concise message, confirmation.

Limits:

Do not invent missing facts or transmit outside license privileges.

First task: start a station log and require every field message to have a source and time.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

SKYWARN Spotter

EMERGENCY COMMUNICATIONS

Scenario credentials: NWS Pittsburgh SKYWARN training certificate.

Capabilities: observe from safety, distinguish reportable hazards, and submit time/location/magnitude/source reports through approved channels.

Certificate meaning:

You are trained to make useful reports; you are not a meteorologist or storm chaser.

Limits:

Never leave shelter to improve a report. Do not estimate what you cannot observe.

Watch: rainfall, rising water, wind damage, hail, lightning, and warnings.

Message Logger / Runner

EMERGENCY COMMUNICATIONS

Scenario credentials: ICS message-handling practice; no radio license needed for non-transmitting duties.

Capabilities: time-stamp messages, preserve exact wording, obtain signatures, deliver paper traffic, and close the loop.

Limits:

Do not change priority, add rumors, or shortcut through a restricted area.

Your rule: If it was not logged, command may not know it happened.

First task: number every message and build incoming/outgoing logs.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Planning / CalTopo Map Unit

SAR OPERATIONS

Scenario credentials: CalTopo for Incident Response/NASAR completion certificate; FEMA IS-100/700.

Capabilities: maintain the common operating picture, create operational periods, mark clues and hazards, build assignments, and produce map packets.

Certificate meaning:

You completed incident-mapping training; you are not automatically a field searcher or incident commander.

Limits:

Protect private locations and mark unverified reports clearly.

First product: time-stamped sectors, hazards, teams, survivors, and unknowns.

Search-Base Documentation

SAR OPERATIONS

Scenario credentials: SARTECH awareness/preparation; ICS documentation practice.

Capabilities: issue assignment numbers, record team members/equipment, support briefing/debriefing, log clues, and track departure/return.

Training meaning:

You understand search-base workflow; it does not authorize unsupervised field search.

Limits:

A team without assignment, supervisor, communications, or return time does not deploy.

Your question: "Who has them, where are they, and when are they due back?"

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Drone Planner / Visual Observer

SAR OPERATIONS

Scenario credentials: Part 107 study completion; supervised flight training. Adult instructor is remote PIC.

Capabilities: analyze airspace/weather, plan a search grid, inspect equipment, act as visual observer, and log imagery.

Training meaning:

Under direct PIC supervision you may manipulate controls; you are not the remote PIC.

Limits:

PIC approves every flight. Maintain visual line of sight; avoid people, emergency aircraft, smoke, and bad weather.

First product: objective, area, hazards, altitude, abort criteria, and image log.

Medical Support Lead

SAR OPERATIONS

Scenario credentials: recognized CPR/AED and basic first-aid course-completion card.

Capabilities: perform within training, organize treatment, request EMS, use PPE, track patients, and advise on supplies.

Card meaning:

You demonstrated basic lifesaving skills; it does not permit diagnosis or independent medical practice.

Limits:

Scene safety first. Fever/exposure decisions require adult medical/public-health direction.

First task: separate immediate first aid, routine needs, and possible exposure with dignity.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Operations / Field Team Coordinator

SAR OPERATIONS

Scenario credentials: FEMA IS-100/700; SARTECH preparation; navigation and radio practice.

Capabilities: turn objectives into supervised assignments, check readiness, coordinate safe reconnaissance, and report status.

Limits:

No student enters a hot zone, unstable building, floodwater, smoke, or zombie-contact area. Training is not operational authority.

First questions: Objective? Supervisor? Communications? Hazards? Withdrawal trigger?

Your power: Recommend a remote method when field risk is unacceptable.

Clue & Evidence Recorder

SAR OPERATIONS

Scenario credentials: CalTopo clue-object and SAR documentation training.

Capabilities: assign clue numbers, record exact location/time/source, photograph when authorized, and update Planning.

Limits:

Do not touch blood, bodies, weapons, medicine, or unknown substances. Do not publish disturbing images.

First task: distinguish observation, inference, and rumor in the clue log.

Warning: The wet handprint on the inside of a locked door is a clue—not an invitation.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Logistics Section Lead

DISASTER LOGISTICS & RECOVERY

Scenario credentials: FEMA IS-100/700; resource-management training.

Capabilities: organize communications, food, supplies, facilities, transport, personnel support, and demobilization.

Limits:

Logistics does not send people on unapproved missions or accept unsafe donations.

First product: resource, quantity, location, condition, owner, request status, and return plan.

Problem: Everyone wants the last batteries. Allocate by incident priority.

Supply & Inventory Manager

DISASTER LOGISTICS & RECOVERY

Scenario credentials: NIMS resource-management practice; OSHA hazard awareness.

Capabilities: receive, inspect, label, store, issue, recover, and document supplies; establish reorder points.

Limits:

Quarantine leaking, spoiled, unlabeled, blood-contaminated, or suspicious donations. Lift safely.

First task: count water, food, PPE, batteries, medical and sanitation supplies, fuel, radios, and sandbags.

Your enemy: donated junk blocking the fire exit.

CUT ON DASHED LINES

Shelter & Feeding Lead

DISASTER LOGISTICS & RECOVERY

Scenario credentials: ServSafe Food Handler Certificate; shelter-support orientation.

Capabilities: design safe food flow, prevent cross-contamination, monitor time/temperature, manage allergens, and log sanitation.

Certificate meaning:

You demonstrated food-handler knowledge; you are not a Food Protection Manager or medical professional.

Limits:

Reject unsafe food. Keep isolation separate from food preparation and general shelter.

First product: feeding schedule, allergy check, handwashing plan, temperature log, and waste route.

Worker Safety & Recovery Lead

DISASTER LOGISTICS & RECOVERY

Scenario credentials: OSHA 10 General Industry course-completion card; sandbag and heat-injury training.

Capabilities: recognize hazards, recommend controls/PPE, design safer work, document near misses, and support cleanup planning.

Card meaning:

OSHA 10 is hazard-awareness training—not a license, certification, or work authorization.

Limits:

Minors do not do demolition, electrical repair, body recovery, confined-space entry, or biohazard cleanup.

First product: hierarchy-of-controls hazard plan.